AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EA300A
Children's Literature (I)
MIDTERM (MAKE UP)
All Branches

2025-2026 /First Semester
Date: 4 Dec. 2025
12:00 – 2:00

Number of Exam Pages: 4 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are TWO sections in this exam paper:

1. You are required to answer TWO questions from Section 1, and ONE question from Section 2.
2. Answers in Section 1 should be in the form of short answers.
3. Answers in section 2 should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis, end with a conclusion, define all important terms, and provide specific and appropriate examples. Analyze and discuss the examples.
4. Edit your answers, paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
5. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
6. It is also necessary to refer to relevant critical essays to support your analysis.

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SECTION 1: SHORT ANSWERS (10 marks)

Answer TWO of the following three questions in 50 words each.

1- Consider how Perrault's Cinderella might change if narrated by the stepmother. Comment on the effect on readers' interpretation. (5 marks)

2- "The stepsisters' exaggerated cruelty in Dahl's satire Cinderella serves a dual purpose." Comment. (5 marks)

3- "In Perrault and Dahl's Cinderella, the treatment of violence reflects each author's audience and purpose. Comment. (5 marks)

SECTION 2: ESSAY WRITING/ CLOSE READING (20 MARKS)

Answer EITHER Question 1 OR Question 2 in 250 WORDS.

Question 1: ESSAY WRITING

"The March household operates as a symbolic battlefield where competing ideologies are enacted." Discuss with reference to the March family and to critics' views on the topic.

OR

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Question 2: CLOSE READING

Analyse the passage from L. M. Alcott's *Little Women* focusing on the tension between material wealth and emotional richness in Meg and John's relationship

John Brooke did his duty manfully for a year, got wounded, was sent home, and not allowed to return. He received no stars or bars, but he deserved them, for he cheerfully risked all he had, and life and love are very precious when both are in full bloom. Perfectly resigned to his discharge, he devoted himself to getting well, preparing for business, and earning a home for Meg. With the good sense and sturdy independence that characterized him, he refused Mr. Laurence's more generous offers, and accepted the place of bookkeeper, feeling better satisfied to begin with an honestly earned salary than by running any risks with borrowed money.

Meg had spent the time in working as well as waiting, growing womanly in character, wise in housewifely arts, and prettier than ever, for love is a great beautifier. She had her girlish ambitions and hopes, and felt some disappointment at the humble way in which the new life must begin. Ned Moffat had just married Sallie Gardiner, and Meg couldn't help contrasting their fine house and carriage, many gifts, and splendid outfit with her own, and secretly wishing she could have the same. But somehow envy and discontent soon vanished when she thought of all the patient love and labor John had put into the little home awaiting her, and when they sat together in the twilight, talking over their small plans, the future always grew so beautiful and bright that she forgot Sallie's splendor and felt herself the richest, happiest girl in Christendom.

***Little Women*, (1868) p. 417-8**

End of Exam

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